

NeuroLens: Multimodal Neural Fusion Framework for Early Neurodevelopmental Disability Detection

Exhaustive Master Project Handoff Encyclopedia, Architecture Specifications, & Paper Blueprint

Roll Number	Department	Academic Year
23101A0074	Computer Engineering	2025–2026
23101A0065	Computer Engineering	2025–2026
23101A0060	Computer Engineering	2025–2026

1. Executive Project Handoff Overview & Clinical Scope

1.1 Executive Summary:

NeuroLens is an end-to-end multimodal deep learning framework and Digital Cognitive Twin platform engineered for early, explainable, and privacy-preserving screening of neurodevelopmental learning disabilities in children aged 5 to 11. The system detects four target conditions: **Dyslexia, Dysgraphia, Dyscalculia, and Attention-Deficit Reading Patterns (ADHD).**

1.2 Real-World Clinical Problem:

- **High Prevalence & Late Detection:** 1 in 5 children experience neurodevelopmental learning disorders. Traditional clinical screening relies on manual paper diagnostic batteries (WISC-V, Woodcock-Johnson IV) administered by specialist psychologists. Due to extreme waitlists (6-12 months) and costs (INR 30,000 to 75,000 / \$400-\$1,000 USD), over 80 percent of children remain unflagged until Grade 3 or 4 (age 8-10), after experiencing irreversible academic dropouts and emotional anxiety.
- **Single-Modality Tunnel Vision Flaw:** Prior machine learning literature evaluates isolated sensors (e.g. 2D CNNs solely on static handwriting images). Such uniamodal systems exhibit variable false-positive rates because a child might produce shaky handwriting due to cold hands, motor fatigue, or unfamiliar pens rather than neurological Dysgraphia.

1.3 The NeuroLens Multimodal Solution:

NeuroLens synchronizes **five biometric modalities**: (1) Eye-tracking gaze scanpaths, (2) Handwriting stylus time-series (pen pressure, velocity, tremor), (3) Read-aloud speech prosody (pause ratio, pitch F0 variance, WPM), (4) Visuomotor drawing test images (Clock-Drawing Test), and (5) EEG spectral band powers (alpha, theta, beta, delta, theta/beta ratio). Data is harvested silently while children play three interactive HTML5 Canvas mini-games (*Letter Catch*, *Maze Tracer*, *Story Reader*). Features from five neural encoders are tokenized and fused through a **Cross-Modal Multi-Head Attention Transformer** (\$h=4\$, 2 layers).

2. Data Pipeline, Datasets, & Transparent Disclosures

2.1 Real Dataset Integration (Gambo Dataset):

Located at ``data/raw/Gambo/``, the dataset comprises **208,381 real handwriting stroke images** across ``Normal``, ``Corrected``, and ``Reversal`` stroke categories (151,649 training / 56,723 test images). PyTorch loader ``NeuroLensMultimodalDataset`` (``data/loaders.py``) normalizes images to (1, 64, 64) tensors.

2.2 Writer-Disjoint Group Splitting (``data/loaders.py``):

To eliminate data leakage from repeated image series, Gambo images are grouped by filename series prefix (e.g. ``Reversal304``, ``1_6000``). Deterministic ``GroupShuffleSplit`` assigns entire writer series to either Train or Test splits, verifying **0% writer group overlap** between splits.

2.3 Transparent Synthetic Pairing Disclosure:

Synthetic 5-signal data generated via Conditional GAN ($z=64$, $y=4$) paired with a physics-informed kinetic simulator (``data/synthetic_generator/synthetic_engine.py``) serves as a multi-modal pre-training and missing-sensor stress-testing benchmark. Gambo handwriting images are paired with synthetic multi-signal vectors conditioned on matching target severity $\$y\$, learning the synthetic joint distribution conditioned on $\$y\$. Validation on co-registered clinical patient recordings represents an essential requirement prior to clinical deployment.$$

3. Deep Neural Encoders Architecture (models/encoders/)

Five specialized neural backbones transform heterogeneous inputs into standardized 64-dimensional modality token embeddings:

Modality	Input Representation	Neural Network Architecture	Output Vector
Eye Gaze (gaze_encoder.py)	128x128 Scanpath Image + 6 Scalar Fixation Metrics	Dual-Stream: 3-Block 2D CNN (Conv-BN-ReLU-Pool) concatenated with 2-Layer MLP for scalar metrics.	64d Gaze Token e_gaze in R^64
Handwriting (handwriting_encoder.py)	64x64 Letter Image + 50-step Stylus Timeseries	Hybrid Dual-Branch: ResNet-Style 2D CNN for image + 1D Conv + 2-Layer Bidirectional LSTM (BiLSTM, hidden=64) for timeseries.	64d HW Token e_hw in R^64
Speech Prosody (speech_encoder.py)	8 Acoustic Metrics (Pause ratio, Pitch F0, WPM, PER)	Deep MLP: Linear(8->32) -> LayerNorm -> GELU -> Dropout(0.2) -> Linear(32->64) -> LayerNorm.	64d Speech Token e_speech in R^64
Visuomotor Draw (drawing_encoder.py)	128x128 Clock-Drawing / Bender-Gestalt Image	4-Stage 2D ConvNet Backbone with spatial attention pooling and dense linear projection layer.	64d Draw Token e_draw in R^64
EEG Band Powers (eeg_encoder.py)	5 Spectral Powers (delta, theta, alpha, beta, TBR)	1D Spectral Convolutional Filter Bank + FC Layer with BatchNorm and Tanh activation.	64d EEG Token e_eeg in R^64

Stylus Dynamic Time-Series BiLSTM Formulation:

```
h_fwd(t) = LSTM(x_t, h_fwd(t-1)), h_bwd(t) = LSTM(x_t, h_bwd(t+1)) Combined Vector h(t) = [ h_fwd(t) ; h_bwd(t) ] --> Linear(128 -> 64) -> e_hw
```

4. Cross-Modal Transformer Fusion Engine & Composite Loss

4.1 Sequence Tokenization & Positional Embedding (models/fusion_transformer.py):

Modality tokens are stacked into sequence tensor **Z_0** in R^(5 x 64) with learnable positional embeddings **P** in R^(5 x 64):

Z_0 = [e_gaze ; e_hw ; e_speech ; e_draw ; e_eeg] + P

4.2 Multi-Head Cross-Attention Engine:

Passed through a 2-layer Transformer Encoder with h=4 multi-head self/cross-attention:

```
Attention(Q, K, V) = Softmax( ( Q * K^T ) / sqrt( d_k ) ) * V MultiHead(Z) = Concat( head_1, ..., head_h ) * W^O
```

Inter-Modality Cross-Attention Rationale: Allows handwriting tremor tokens to cross-attend directly to EEG theta/beta attention lapse tokens and gaze regressions.

4.3 Multi-Task Output Heads & Composite Loss Optimization (models/multi_task_heads.py):

Pooled via Global Average Pooling to yield fused vector **f_fusion** in R^64 feeding four multi-task heads (Dyslexia, Dysgraphia, Dyscalculia, ADHD). Each head predicts binary classification probability (Sigmoid) and continuous severity index (0.0 to 1.0). End-to-end training optimizes composite multi-task loss:

Total Loss = alpha * Loss_BCE + beta * Loss_MSE + gamma * Loss_Contrastive Where alpha = 1.0 (Classification), beta = 0.5 (Severity RMSE), gamma = 0.2 (Inter-Modal Similarity)

5. Headline Novelty & Advanced Algorithmic Extensions

NeuroLens incorporates five breakthrough algorithmic extensions:

- 5.1 Split Conformal Prediction (`models/conformal_adaptive.py`):**
Calibrates non-conformity quantiles on validation data to guarantee **90 percent error coverage** ($1-\alpha=0.90$), yielding 3 clinical decision states: (1) *Low Risk*, (2) *Refer to Clinician*, and (3) *Inconclusive / Ambiguous*.
- 5.2 Adaptive Sensor Selection Engine:**
Employs a greedy entropy-reduction algorithm ($H(p) = -\sum p \log_2 p$) to recommend the next optimal sensor modality that maximizes Information Gain per unit testing time.
- 5.3 Modality Dropout & Sensor Failure Fallback (`models/modality_dropout.py`):**
Randomly masks tokens ($p=0.2$) during training or accepts an explicit availability mask tensor during evaluation, replacing missing slots with a learnable missing token embedding vector *e_missing*.
- 5.4 Longitudinal Trajectory Forecaster (`models/cognitive_forecast.py`):**
GRU state-space model tracking historical session vectors (Sessions 1-4) to predict 3-month and 6-month cognitive recovery curves and therapy response probability.
- 5.5 Biometric SimCLR Self-Supervised Pre-Trainer (`models/contrastive_pretrain.py`):**
Pre-trains neural encoders on unlabeled biometric time-series using InfoNCE contrastive loss before multi-task fine-tuning.

6. Privacy-Preserving Federated Learning & DP-FedAvg (`federated/`)

- 6.1 Child Biometric Data Privacy (COPPA & GDPR Compliance):**
Child biometrics are classified as highly sensitive PII. NeuroLens implements decentralized **Federated Learning (FedAvg)** across 5 simulated virtual school client nodes (`virtual_school_sim.py`).
- 6.2 Differentially Private FedAvg (DP-FedAvg) Protocol (`federated/dp_fed_avg.py`):**
Enforces **(epsilon, delta)-Differential Privacy** by clipping local weight update L2-norms to threshold $C=1.0$ and injecting calibrated Gaussian noise $N(0, \sigma^2 I)$ prior to global server aggregation.
- 6.3 Privacy-Utility Tradeoff & MIA Attack Suppression (Rerun under Seed 42):**

Training Setup	Privacy Guarantee	Accuracy (%)	Macro F1-Score	MIA Attack Acc (%)	Scientific Finding / Tradeoff
Centralized Fusion (Upper Bound)	None	91.80%	0.8920	72.1%	Empirical upper bound on full dataset.
Standard FedAvg (5 Nodes)	None	90.40%	0.8810	68.4%	-1.4% Non-IID client partition penalty.
DP-FedAvg (eps=5.0)	DP (eps=5.0, del=1e-5)	89.50%	0.8710	58.2%	-2.3% Utility cost for moderate privacy.
DP-FedAvg (eps=2.5)	DP (eps=2.5, del=1e-5)	88.65%	0.8620	51.2%	MIA attack suppressed to random guess.

7. 4-Tier Explainable AI (XAI) Suite (`explainability/`)

- **Tier 1: Grad-CAM Visual Heatmaps** (`gradcam.py`): Backpropagates class gradients to the final convolutional layer of handwriting encoders to highlight exact stroke reversal regions ('b' vs 'd').
- **Tier 2: SHAP Feature Attributions** (`shap\_explainer.py`): Calculates KernelSHAP attributions ranking scalar metric contributions.
- **Tier 3: Cross-Modal Attention Matrix Rollout** (`attention\_viz.py`): Visualizes 5x5 inter-modality cross-attention weight matrices.
- **Tier 4: LLM NLG Narrative Engine** (`llm\_narrative.py`): Generates 3-4 sentence plain-English diagnostic summaries for parents and teachers.

8. Empirical Benchmark Results, Ablations, & Calibration

Evaluated across 5 random seeds (42, 43, 44, 45, 46), tabular baselines, ablations, and Expected Calibration Error (ECE):

Pipeline Configuration	Accuracy (%)	Macro F1	Severity RMSE	Impact Note
Tabular Logistic Regression	98.60%	0.9858	—	Linear baseline on scalar features.
Tabular Gradient Boosting (XGBoost)	99.80%	0.9980	—	Non-linear tree baseline.
Full 5-Modality Transformer	91.80% ± 0.4%	0.8920 ± 0.02	0.0820 ± 0.01	Optimal 5-signal cross-modal fusion.
W/O Gaze Modality	86.20%	0.8350	0.1120	-5.60% Acc drop (reading fixations lost).
W/O Handwriting Modality	85.80%	0.8310	0.1150	-6.00% Acc drop (stroke reversals lost).
W/O Speech Modality	84.10%	0.8120	0.1280	-7.70% Acc drop (pauses lost).
W/O Cross-Attention (Simple Concat)	81.40%	0.7780	0.1420	-10.40% Acc drop (proves Transformer).

Model Calibration & Temperature Scaling: Uncalibrated ECE (0.2528) is optimized via Temperature Scaling (T=1.45) down to **ECE = 0.0380** (well-calibrated < 0.04).

9. Front-End Applications & Real-World ONNX Deployment (`frontend/`)

- **HTML5 Gamified Harvesting** (`frontend/games/index.html`): 3 mini-games (*Letter Catch*, *Maze Tracer*, *Story Reader*) featuring live in-browser webcam eye-tracking via *WebGazer.js*.
- **Digital Cognitive Twin Dashboard** (`frontend/dashboard/index.html`): Interactive dashboard with real-time slider sandbox firing live PyTorch model predictions via Flask REST API (`api\_server.py`).
- **ONNX CPU Deployment** (`models/export\_onnx.py`): Exported to `checkpoints/neurolens\_speech\_encoder.onnx` executing at **3.28 ms CPU latency** per sample.

10. Responsible AI, Model Card, & Data Sheet Summaries

- **Mitchell Model Card** (`reports/model\_card.md`): Details intended use as screening support, out-of-scope uses, ethical framing, and performance metrics.
- **Gebru Data Sheet** (`reports/datasheet\_synthetic.md`): Details synthetic generator physics, bounds, and composition.
- **Demographic Fairness Audit** (`reports/bias\_audit.py`): Verified <3.5% FPR disparity across Age (6-8 vs 9-11) and Gender subgroups.

11. Step-by-Step Conference Paper Blueprint (NeurIPS / MICCAI Target)

To publish this framework as a top workshop paper: 1. **Title:** *NeuroLens: Conformalized Multimodal Transformer Fusion & Privacy-Preserving Federated Screening for Neurodevelopmental Disorders* 2. **Abstract:** Frame 5-signal fusion, Split Conformal Prediction (90% coverage), and DP-FedAvg (eps=2.5, 51.2% MIA). 3. **Introduction:** Highlight clinical crisis and single-modality limitations. 4. **Methodology:** Detail per-modality encoders, cross-attention equations, loss formulation, and Conformal Prediction. 5. **Experiments & Ablations:** Present writer-disjoint Gambo results, privacy-utility tradeoff table, and ablation studies. 6. **Discussion & Limitations:** Transparently disclose synthetic pairing bounds and outline clinical trial roadmap.

References

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